AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

HIGHER SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS XI

ANNUAL EXAMINATIONS (THEORY) 2025

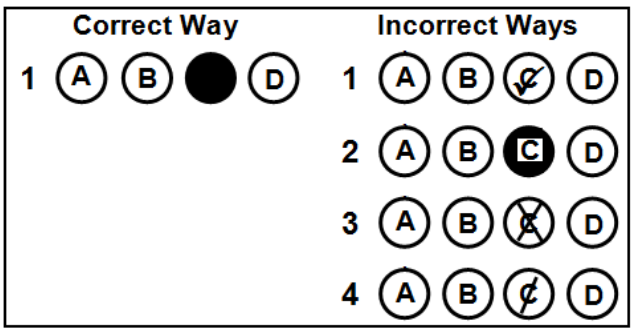
English Compulsory Paper I

Time: 55 minutes Marks: 40

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INSTRUCTIONS

1. Read each question carefully.
2. Answer the questions on the separate answer sheet provided. DO NOT write your answers on the question paper.
3. There are 100 answer numbers on the answer sheet. Use answer numbers 1 to 40 only.
4. In each question, there are four choices A, B, C, D. Choose ONE. On the answer grid, black out the circle for your choice with a pencil as shown below.



Candidate's Signature

5. If you want to change your answer, ERASE the first answer completely with a rubber, before blacking out a new circle.
6. DO NOT write anything in the answer grid. The computer only records what is in the circles.

Listening Comprehension Section

In this section you will hear two passages. Each one will be played two times.

Listen carefully to the first passage and then read questions 1 to 10. You will have two minutes' reading time.

The passage will then be played again. You can make notes on your question paper.

When the passage has finished, enter your answers on your separate answer sheet. You will have three minutes to pencil in your answers.

Follow the instructions on the front page of Paper I to show which of the options, A, B, C, or D, you have selected for each question.

Listening Passage I

This recording talks about bottled water.

Source: Adapted from '*All Bottled Up*' by Judie Mangor and incorporates information from The Express Tribune

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

1. How does the speaker introduce her topic?

   A. By mentioning the benefits of bottled water
   B. By mentioning various examples of bottled water intake
   C. By mentioning the increase in the demand of bottled water
   D. By mentioning the health implication of using bottled water

2. The FIRST reason given by the speaker for the increase in the consumption of bottled water is that

   A. it is healthier than sugary and caffeinated drinks.
   B. the standard of bottled water vary from place to place.
   C. bottled water is easily available everywhere in the world.
   D. the companies selling bottled water guarantee its purity.

3. According to the speaker, the general perception amongst public about tap water is that it is

   A. pure.
   B. pristine.
   C. unhealthy.
   D. from the glaciers.

4. According to the speaker, what marketing strategy is used for selling bottled water?

   A. Some evidences are given to convey the idea of brand value.
   B. Quoting the findings of surveys by Pakistan Council of Research.
   C. Prices of bottled water are usually kept high due to better quality.
   D. Specific words and images are used to convey the idea of cleanliness.

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5. What does the speaker say about 40% of bottled water?

   A. 40% of bottled water is not healthy.
   B. 40% of bottled water is basically tap water.
   C. 40% of bottled water impacts environment negatively.
   D. 40% of the bottled water has high quantity of minerals.

6. According to the speaker, Pakistan Council of Research in Water Resources has found that some brands sell

   A. contaminated bottled water.
   B. bottled water across many continents.
   C. expensive bottled water during natural disasters.
   D. bottled water in plastic containers which is healthier.

7. The speaker says, "At times, bottled water is the best available option." Which information is given IMMEDIATELY after this?

   A. Water can be contaminated by plastics and chemicals.
   B. Natural disasters negatively affect the safety of drinking water.
   C. In developing countries drinking water is generally unhealthy.
   D. Many companies have tried to improve the quality of bottled water.

8. According to the speaker, what step should be taken by the companies to ensure the quality of bottled water?

   A. Bottled water should be stored in clean jars.
   B. Amount of plastic should be reduced from the containers of bottled water.
   C. Better machines and supplements should be used to clean tap water.
   D. Better strategies should be used to increase awareness about bottled water.

9. The speaker provides information through

   A. figurative expressions.
   B. factual evidence.
   C. chronology.
   D. opinions.

10. The heard passage is on the subject of

   A. Environmental Studies.
   B. Public Relations.
   C. Geography.
   D. History.

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Now, we will play the second passage. It will also be played two times.

Listen carefully to the second passage, and then read questions 11 to 20. You will have two minutes' reading time. The passage will then be played again.

When the passage has finished, enter your answers on your separate answer sheet. You will have three minutes to pencil in your answers.

Listening Passage II

In this recording, the speaker talks about content writing.

Source: Taken from an article published on https://www.simplilearn.com

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

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11. The heard passage begins by

    A. defining what content writing is.
    B. stating the importance of content writers.
    C. explaining different purposes of education.
    D. describing various types of writing techniques.

12. The speaker describes content writers as those professionals who

    A. manage the media.
    B. work only for social media.
    C. develop correspondence for a variety of media.
    D. entertain people through performing in the media.

13. The speaker suggests that the FIRST step towards being a content writer is to

    A. develop relationships with fellow writers.
    B. conduct workshops on writing skills.
    C. improve one's writing abilities.
    D. create a portfolio.

14. The speaker mentions that 'Content writing jobs often provide flexibility…'

    The information given IMMEDIATELY before this is about the

    A. impact of content writing.
    B. media where content writers can publish in.
    C. significance of writing for in-house businesses only.
    D. freedom given to writers to work according to their schedules.

15. Consider the given sentence from the heard passage.

    'content writing jobs present an avenue…'

    Another word that could replace the underlined word in the given sentence is

    A. gifts.
    B. offer.
    C. tense.
    D. attendance.

16. Content writing is frequently confused with creative writing, but it is more about utility than creativity.

    The underlined words in the given sentence from the heard passage contextually show

    A. exaggeration.
    B. determination.
    C. differentiation.
    D. experimentation.

17. Based on the information in the heard passage, the job prospects for content writers in the future is

    A. promising.
    B. stagnant.
    C. unsure.
    D. grim.

18. The tone of the heard passage is

    A. apologetic.
    B. objective.
    C. reflective.
    D. sarcastic.

19. The speaker's purpose is to

    A. entertain.
    B. explain.
    C. narrate.
    D. argue.

20. A suitable title for the given passage could be

    A. '*How to Develop Content*'.
    B. '*The Importance of Social Media*'.
    C. '*Significance of Being a Content Writer*'.
    D. '*Ways to Create a Professional Environment*'.

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Reading Comprehension Section

You have 30 minutes' time for the reading comprehension section. This section has two reading passages; each followed by 10 multiple choice questions. You are advised to spend approximately 15 minutes on each of the given passages.

Read the passage carefully and then answer the multiple choice questions which follow.

Reading Passage I

Fort Munro is a historical fort located in the Dera Ghazi Khan district of Punjab province, Pakistan. The fort is situated at an altitude of 6,470 feet above sea level and is surrounded by beautiful mountain ranges, making it a popular tourist destination for nature lovers and history enthusiasts alike.

The fort was originally built during the British Raj in the late 19th century as a military outpost to control the Balochistan region. It was strategically located at the junction of three different mountain ranges and was used as a base for several military expeditions in the area.

Fort Munro is a popular tourist destination that attracts visitors from all over Pakistan and beyond. The fort is accessible by road and is located approximately 185 kilometres from the city of Multan. The road leading to the fort is well-maintained and offers stunning views of the surrounding mountains and valleys.

During the hot summer, it attracts many people for short stays. It is about 85 kilometres from the city of Dera Ghazi Khan, Punjab, Pakistan and is directly connected to the National Highway. The people of Fort Munro are nomads, mainly of the Leghari tribe...To reach Fort Munro hill station, you have to reach Dera Ghazi Khan first. It would take you barely an hour or so to get to Fort Munro by car or one of the available bus services which are very affordable.

A state-of-the-art bridge is also under construction on National Highway in this hilly area, the first phase of which has already been opened. Once fully completed and operational, this infrastructure project will provide safer and more convenient road connectivity…to one of the most famous hill stations in Pakistan…

In addition to the fort, there are several other attractions in the Fort Munro area that visitors can explore. These include the beautiful Mubarak Village, the scenic Koh-e-Suleiman range, and the picturesque Kalapani Dam, which is located near the fort and offers stunning views of the surrounding area. Visitors can also enjoy several outdoor activities in the Fort Munro area, such as trekking, hiking, and camping. The scenic mountain ranges and lush green forests offer plenty of opportunities for outdoor adventure and exploration…One of the main attractions of Fort Munro is its cool and pleasant climate, which is a welcome respite from the hot and humid weather in other parts of Punjab. The area experiences heavy snowfall during the winter months, making it an ideal destination for winter sports enthusiasts.

Source: Adapted from https://www.pakistantraveler.com/fort-munro-weather/

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Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

21. Which of the following sentences can be used to enhance the meaning of paragraph 1?

    A. There are many places in the world which were occupied by the British.
    B. If you want to visit historical locations, Fort Munro is the place to go.
    C. People should visit places to understand political landscapes.
    D. We should only visit locations that teach us about history.

22. Paragraph 1 is organised to show

    A. elaboration.
    B. speculation.
    C. reflections.
    D. solutions.

23. In paragraph 5, the underlined term ‘state-of-the-art’ contextually means

    A. various states of art.
    B. highly developed.
    C. futuristic.
    D. popular.

24. Which of the following senses does the author use to describe the surrounding areas of Fort Munro?

    A. Visual
    B. Auditory
    C. Gustatory (taste)
    D. Olfactory (smell)

25. Based on the information in the given passage, Fort Munro was originally developed as a

    A. tourist destination.
    B. base for armed forces.
    C. resting point for travellers.
    D. junction to reach the highway.

26. All of the following aspects of Fort Munro are mentioned by the author EXCEPT its

    A. structural elements.
    B. points of interests.
    C. location.
    D. history.

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27. It can be inferred from the last paragraph that the best time to visit Fort Munro is during

I. summers
II. winters
III. spring

A. I only.
B. III only.
C. I and II.
D. II and III.

28. The purpose of the author is to

A. compare various areas of Pakistan.
B. promote tourism and love for nature.
C. suggest that people become architects.
D. trace the history of the British Empire.

29. A suitable title for the given passage could be

A. '*Ways to Enjoy Your Summers*'.
B. '*The Legend of the British Empire*'.
C. '*Fort Munro: Guarding the Unknown*'.
D. '*Fascinating Places to Visit in Pakistan*'.

30. Based on the information in the given passage, which of the following advices would you give to a person with no knowledge of Fort Munro?

A. If you are a football fan, then Fort Munro is the ideal place to play the game in the summers.
B. Visiting Fort Munro will enhance your understanding of the past and appreciate heritage.
C. You should dress appropriately for the weather and for your own personal safety.
D. You should only visit Fort Munro through affordable transportation services.

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Now read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.

Reading Passage II

I spent much of my childhood watching movies. I became absolutely engrossed in many different films, TV shows, and animations. From the movie theatres to the TV, I spent my hours enjoying the beauty of visual media. One place that was special to me was the car. My parents purchased a special screen that could be mounted on the back of the headrest, so that I could watch movies on trips. This benefited both parties, as I was occupied, and they had peace. Looking back, I realise this screen played a crucial role in my childhood. It was an integral part of many journeys. I remember taking a drive to Washington D.C*, with my visiting relatives from Poland, and spending my time with my eyes on the screen. I remember packing up my possessions and moving to my current home from Queens**, watching my cartoons the whole time. I can comfortably say that watching movies in the car has been a familiar anchor during times of change in my life.

I used to watch many different cartoons, nature documentaries, and other products in the car, yet there has been one movie that I have rewatched constantly. It is called '*Kiki's Delivery Service*' by Hayao Miyazaki. My parents picked it up at a garage sale one day, and I fell in love. The style of the animations was beautiful, and the captivating story of a thirteen-year-old witch leaving home really appealed to me. To be honest, the initial times I watched it, I didn't fully understand the story, but the magic and beauty just made me happy. Then, the more I watched it, I began to see that it was more about independence, including the need to get away from home and establish yourself as your own person. This mirrors how I felt during that period of my life, with me having a little rebellious streak; I didn't agree with my parents on certain topics. That is not the end of the story though. As the years passed, and I watched it a couple more times, although with less frequency than before, my view of this movie evolved yet again.

Instead of solely thinking about the need for independence, I began to think the movie was more about the balance of independence and reliance. In the movie, the girl finds herself struggling until she begins to accept help from others. Looking back, the film also follows my own philosophy during this time. As I began to mature, I began to realise the value of family, and accept all the help I can get from them. I appreciate all the hard work they had done for me, and I recognise their experience in life and take advantage of it. I passed through my rebellious phase, and this reflected in my analysis of the movie…This movie is one of the most important to me throughout my life.

*Washington D.C: capital city of United States of America
**Queens: a district/ town in New York, United States of America

Source: Taken from '*I Spent Much of My Childhood Watching Movies*' by Anonymous

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Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

31. Paragraph 1 focuses on the author's

    A. connection with films during his/ her travels.
    B. relationship with his/ her relatives.
    C. love for Washington DC.
    D. experience in Poland.

32. The underlined word 'my eyes on the screen' in line 8 means that the

    A. author was physically stuck to the screen.
    B. author's eyes were literally shown on the screen.
    C. author was very interested in watching the screen.
    D. author's eyes were weak due to too much screentime.

33. Based on the information in paragraph 2 about the film '*Kiki's Delivery Service*', the film was about

    A. a garage sale.
    B. the history of animation.
    C. the journey of a young girl's life.
    D. an actual delivery service provider.

34. The author's view on the film '*Kiki's Delivery Service*', from his/ her childhood to adulthood, can be depicted as

    A. unenthusiastic.
    B. materialistic.
    C. regressive.
    D. reflective.

35. All of the following adjectives describe the author's overall relationship with his/ her parents EXCEPT

    A. complicated.
    B. healthy.
    C. distant.
    D. tense.

36. Based on the information in the given passage, an advice you would give to the author is to

    A. become an animator in the future.
    B. be charitable when helping others.
    C. create new forms of entertainment.
    D. develop a growth mindset in any situation.

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37. All types of visual media are mentioned by the author EXCEPT

A. cartoons.
B. podcasts.
C. documentaries.
D. television shows.

38. The author provides information MAINLY through

A. investigations.
B. comparisons.
C. descriptions.
D. suggestions.

39. The MAIN theme of the given passage is

A. childhood.
B. adventure.
C. business.
D. beauty.

40. The text type of the given passage is a/ an

A. biography.
B. news report.
C. autobiography.
D. research article.

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END OF PAPER

Please use this page for rough work

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